

BMI, BMR & TDEE Reference Guide

Body Mass Index (BMI)

Formula (metric): BMI = weight in kilograms divided by height in meters squared.

Formula (imperial): BMI = 703 x weight in pounds divided by height in inches squared.

BMI Range	Category
Below 18.5	Underweight
18.5 - 24.9	Normal weight
25.0 - 29.9	Overweight
30.0 and above	Obese

BMI is a simple screening tool and does not directly measure body fat percentage; it can misclassify very muscular individuals as overweight.

Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR) - Mifflin-St Jeor Equation

Men: BMR = (10 x weight in kg) + (6.25 x height in cm) - (5 x age in years) + 5

Women: BMR = (10 x weight in kg) + (6.25 x height in cm) - (5 x age in years) - 161

Considered one of the more accurate BMR equations for the general population compared to older formulas like Harris-Benedict.

Total Daily Energy Expenditure (TDEE)

Activity Level	Description	Multiplier
Sedentary	Little or no exercise, desk job	BMR x 1.2
Lightly Active	Light exercise 1-3 days/week	BMR x 1.375
Moderately Active	Moderate exercise 3-5 days/week	BMR x 1.55
Very Active	Hard exercise 6-7 days/week	BMR x 1.725
Extra Active	Very hard exercise, physical job	BMR x 1.9

TDEE = BMR x Activity Multiplier. Adjust by a deficit or surplus based on the goal.

Goal-Based Calorie Adjustment

Fat loss: TDEE minus roughly 300-500 kcal/day.

Muscle gain: TDEE plus roughly 200-300 kcal/day.

Maintenance: calories approximately equal to TDEE.